



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Calhoun Christian School
School Website: <https://calhounchristian.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Classicality Audit: Berean Christian Academy (Katy, TX)**

Website used: <https://bereanchristianacademy.org>

Executive Summary - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Why: The school explicitly grounds itself in a Christ-centered worldview ordered to Truth, Goodness, and Beauty; integrates theology across the curriculum; offers the Trivium (Grammar–Logic–Rhetoric) with Latin, Great Books, Harkness discussion, debate, and a defended Senior Thesis; and describes a parent–school partnership and robust communal life with chapels and service. These map tightly to the positive indicators in the Six Essential Elements keyword framework used for this audit. - Affiliations: ACCS and SCL (among others) reinforce the classical identity. - Highest strengths: Religious and metaphysical foundations; purpose and telos; curriculum content (Trivium, Latin, Great Books, history by eras); rhetoric capstones (Senior Thesis). - Main gaps to watch: Fewer explicit lower-school pedagogical markers such as chanting/memory work and scholé/restful learning language in public materials.

Note on method and lexicon - This audit used the Six Essential Elements keyword framework and lexicon of positive and negative indicators across six categories (Religious/Metaphysical; Purpose/Goal; Curriculum; Pedagogy; Faculty; Parents & Community). Keyword hits were counted from the school's public materials and compared to the positive/negative lists to compute category scores and coverage estimates.

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations - School keywords found (examples) - “Christ-centered worldview”; “Truth, Goodness, and Beauty”; “for the glory of Christ” (mission) - Theology, Apologetics, Philosophy in course plan; theology as “Queen of Sciences” - “Christmas Chapel,” “Bridge Ceremony Chapel,” “Commencement Chapel”; Good Friday/Easter breaks (liturgical/chapel calendar) - Mapping to Six Elements lexicon - Positive indicators matched: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, Christian worldview, apologetics, chapel (liturgical practices). - Negative indicators: none observed. - Quantitative estimate - pos_neg_hits: +10/-0 - percent_positive: 1.00 - percent_coverage: 0.95 (all three sub-parts—transcendentals, theology, communal worship—appear; worship language is present mainly via chapel events) - Score: CLASSICAL

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal - School keywords found (examples) - Educate in a Christ-centered worldview; equip to recognize Truth, Goodness, Beauty; formation for the “glory of Christ and benefit of others” (telos) - Portrait of a Graduate emphasizes virtue, wisdom, love of truth, well-read and appreciative of beauty; “We hope to equip every graduate, not only to make a living, but to live” - Mapping to Six Elements lexicon - Positive indicators matched: cultivation of wisdom and virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; formation (not mere information). - Negative indicators (e.g., “college and career readiness” emphasis): not present; notably, the school does not offer AP and orients upper-school capstones toward rhetoric and public defense instead. - Quantitative estimate - pos_neg_hits: +8/-0 - percent_positive: 1.00 - percent_coverage: 0.85 (strong telos/formation language; room to make “formation” terminology even more explicit across pages) - Score: CLASSICAL

Element 3: School Curriculum - School keywords found (examples) - Seven liberal arts; Trivium (Grammar–Logic–Rhetoric) with Latin; Great Books and “original ancient texts”; formal Logic, Rhetoric I–II; defended Senior Thesis; history by eras (Ancient/Medieval/Modern) - Extensive upper-school humanities reading list (Odyssey, Herodotus, Augustine, Shakespeare, Federalist/Anti-Federalist, Lewis, etc.) evidences Great

Books/primary texts orientation - Mapping to Six Elements lexicon - Positive indicators matched: liberal arts, Trivium, Latin, Great Books/primary sources, rhetoric/oratory, the Great Conversation; robust history (not “social studies”). - Negative indicators: none (no “social studies” terminology displacing history; projects like Science Fair/Mock Trial appear as capstones within a classical spine, not as a project-based ideology). - Quantitative estimate - pos_neg_hits: +12/-0 - percent_positive: 1.00 - percent_coverage: 0.95 - Score: CLASSICAL

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods - School keywords found (examples) - Harkness Table conversation; formal Logic and Debate; oratory and public defense (Senior Thesis) - Oral presentations in Logic capstones; thesis defense to a panel and community (rhetoric-in-action) - Mapping to Six Elements lexicon - Positive indicators matched: Socratic/Harkness discussion, dialectic, debate, rhetoric/oratory, disputation/defense. - Missing/less explicit in public materials: lower-school chanting/singing/memory work; explicit scholé/restful learning language. - Negative indicators (e.g., constructivist/project-based rhetoric dominance): not observed. - Quantitative estimate - pos_neg_hits: +6/-0 - percent_positive: 1.00 - percent_coverage: 0.60 (upper school pedagogy is very strong; elementary-specific markers like chanting/recitation are not clearly advertised) - Score: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Element 5: School Faculty - School keywords found (examples) - “Portrait of a Berean Christian Academy Teacher” (a teacher is a disciple who models love for God/obedience to His Word) - Faculty are degreed; many hold advanced degrees; faculty advising for thesis (mentor-like role) - Mapping to Six Elements lexicon - Positive indicators matched: portrait of a teacher; teachers as models of virtue; mentorship (advisors in rhetoric/thesis). - Negative indicators: none observed. - Quantitative estimate - pos_neg_hits: +3/-0 - percent_positive: 1.00 - percent_coverage: 0.70 (portrait/virtue modeling present; could add public language on collegial culture/faculty formation in classical pedagogy) - Score: CLASSICAL

Element 6: School Parents and Community - School keywords found (examples) - “Partnership between faculty and parents” (mission) - Admissions includes a “parent interview” to align goals and philosophy (co-education of the child) - Community/chapel events and Prospective Parents Night; parent coffees; house competitions and service as communal anchors - Mapping to Six Elements lexicon - Positive indicators matched: partnership with families; intentional community life; formation of affections through common worship and service. - Negative indicators: none observed. - Quantitative estimate - pos_neg_hits: +5/-0 - percent_positive: 1.00 - percent_coverage: 0.75 - Score: CLASSICAL

Overall Assessment - Aggregate rating: CLASSICAL - Rationale: Strong evidence across five categories with a classical telos, theological integration, and a liberal-arts curriculum anchored by the Trivium, Latin, Great Books, and rhetoric culminations. Pedagogy is clearly dialectical and rhetorical in upper school; lower-school memory/chanting/scholé language is less visible publicly and represents the principal documentation gap to address.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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